came to Bangladesh, Kissinger continued to emphasize the potential for greater US-India shared interests than Sino-US ones. And American aid to Bangladesh was aiding stability there, which India supported.[35] As for China, while it was no longer the glue keeping the two countries together, it was also no longer the reason for conflict or even as much of a reason for the US and India to keep their distance.

Sino-US Relations and India (1973–1976)

The US rapprochement with China continued to develop over the rest of the Nixon and Ford administrations, albeit at a slower pace than some had expected. In early 1973, Kissinger told Chinese policymakers that the administration would move to normalize relations fully after the midterm elections the next year. He expected that the process would be complete by the middle of 1976. However, the Watergate scandal delayed substantial progress. When Ford replaced Nixon as president in August 1974, he and Kissinger assured Chinese officials that the US would honor the commitments made under Nixon.

The US took some steps, such as completing the withdrawal of all fighter aircraft from Taiwan. It also moved forward on offering China economic, defense, intelligence, and technology cooperation. However, with setbacks abroad in Cambodia and Vietnam, and domestic displeasure with détente growing, especially on the right, the process stalled under the Ford administration. The Nixon and Ford administrations were aware of resultant Chinese frustration, as well as Beijing's questions about whether the developing American détente with the Soviet Union was causing the delays.[36] Chinese officials also continued to express concerns about growing Soviet influence in the subcontinent, the Middle East, and the Indian Ocean, holding the US lack of effort as responsible.[37]

Given Chinese sensitivities, American officials were concerned about how Beijing might view their efforts to improve relations with India. Kissinger told Nixon that the US had to be careful about Chinese sentiments as its policy toward Delhi or Moscow evolved. Kissinger described for the president the "scolding" he received from Chinese policymakers during his February 1973 trip to China for not doing enough about Soviet power. Zhou had asserted to him that Delhi and Moscow were